



creative incubator

product & retail design

Project Timeline: 3rd Year [2020]

Location: Pretoria Central, South Africa

Approach: Adaptive reuse

Software: AutoCAD, Adobe Photoshop
& Illustrator



Eliminate. Regenerate. Illuminate.

Project Overview

the brief

To design a *retail creative incubator which focused on a closed loop design process* situated in 012 Central in Pretoria. The store focuses on the *sale and production* of a *uniquely designed upcycled luminaire*.

the problem identified

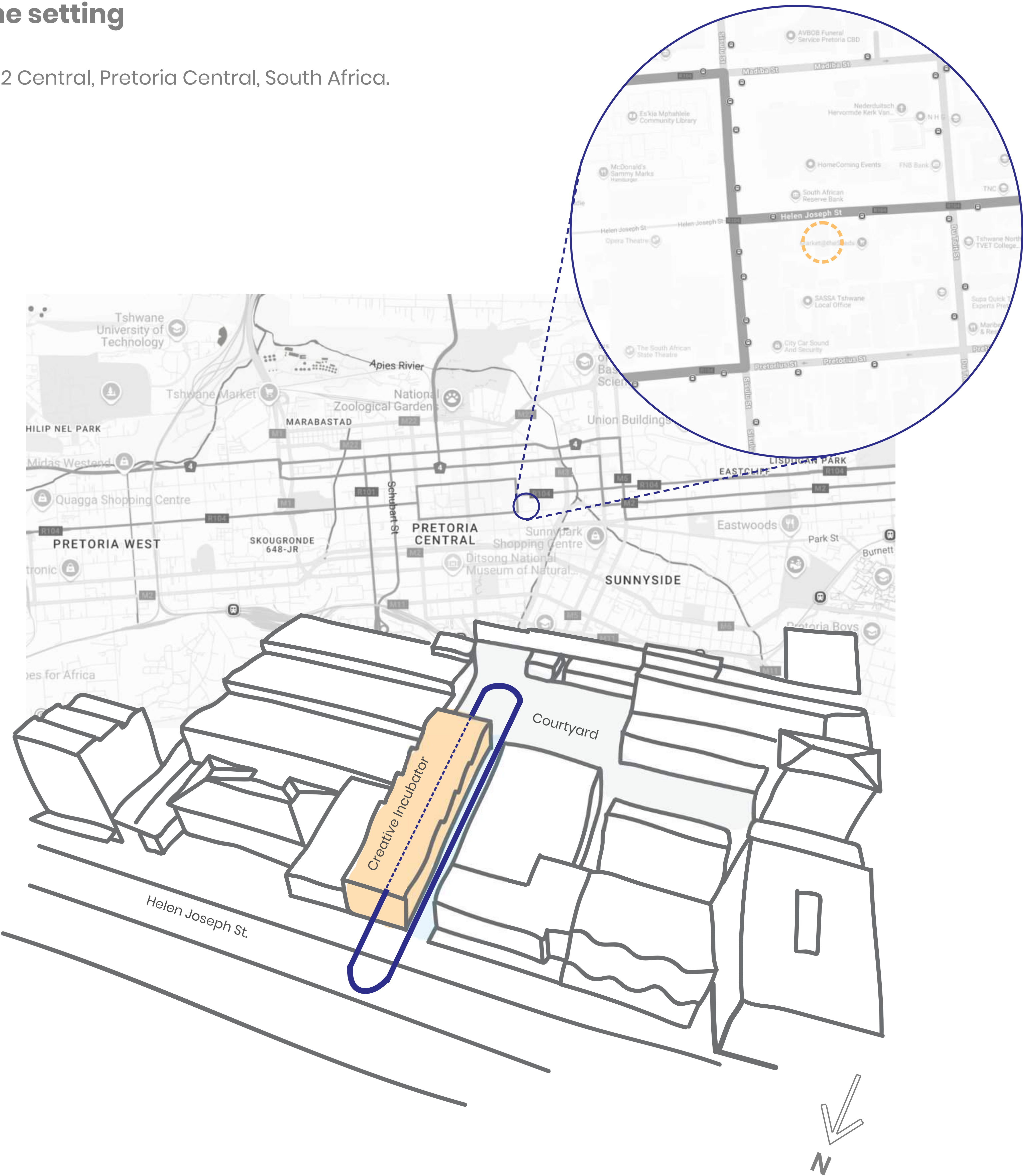
Designing a retail space and creative incubator which *challenges consumerist society retail* while highlighting the *importance of supporting local designers and closed loop design*.

the solution

The solution was to *design and create a store inspired by the materials used in the creation of the luminaire* which draws attention to the *plastic wastage* within our oceans as a result of uneducated and irresponsible citizens. Thus, Cinergy [name of retail store] seeks to holistically provide a platform greater than the boundaries of the store by creating an *integrative and educational approach* of bringing this plastic awareness to an inner city environment.

the setting

012 Central, Pretoria Central, South Africa.



Upcycled Product Design

our floating ocean

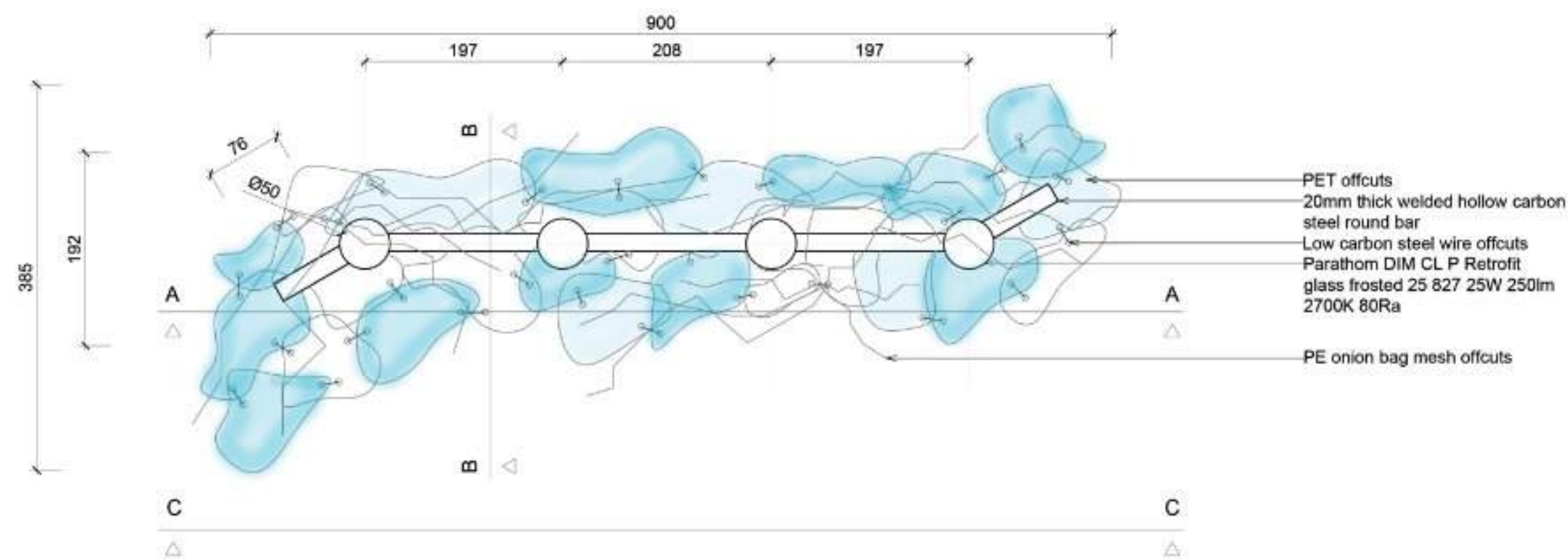
A luminaire which brings environmental awareness using familiar consumer products innovatively creating a form inspired by the plastic ocean gyre narrative.



experimentation

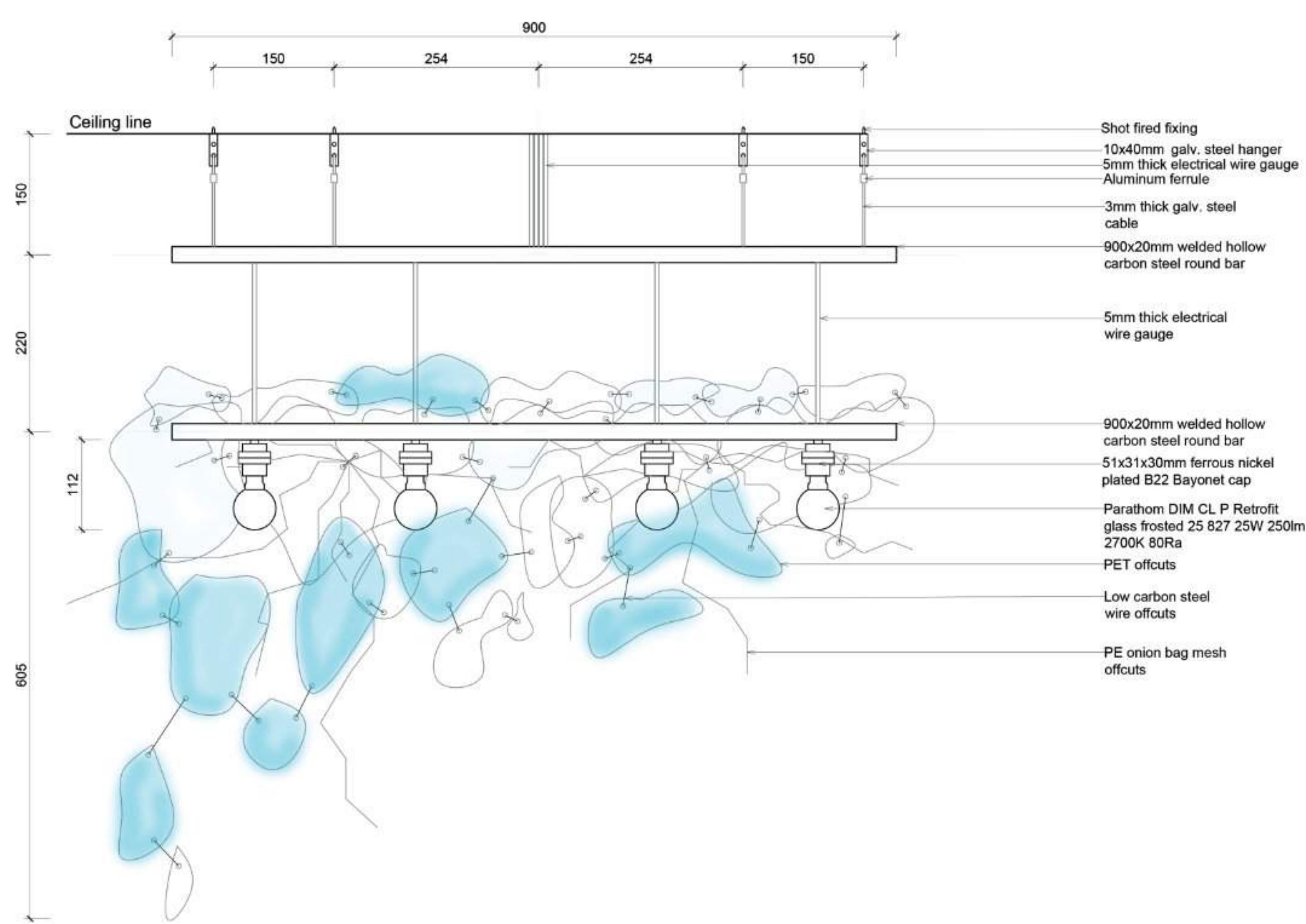
The problem identified: Creating a luminaire which elevated waste products rather than looking as if it was created from waste and ensuring the luminaire was designed in a cradle to cradle manner.

Solution: The solution to the problem was to design and make a luminaire using plastic as the main material, using the full bottle, ensuring no waste created in the making of the luminaire. All joinery methods are from waste materials such as onion bag mesh and steel wire off-cuts.



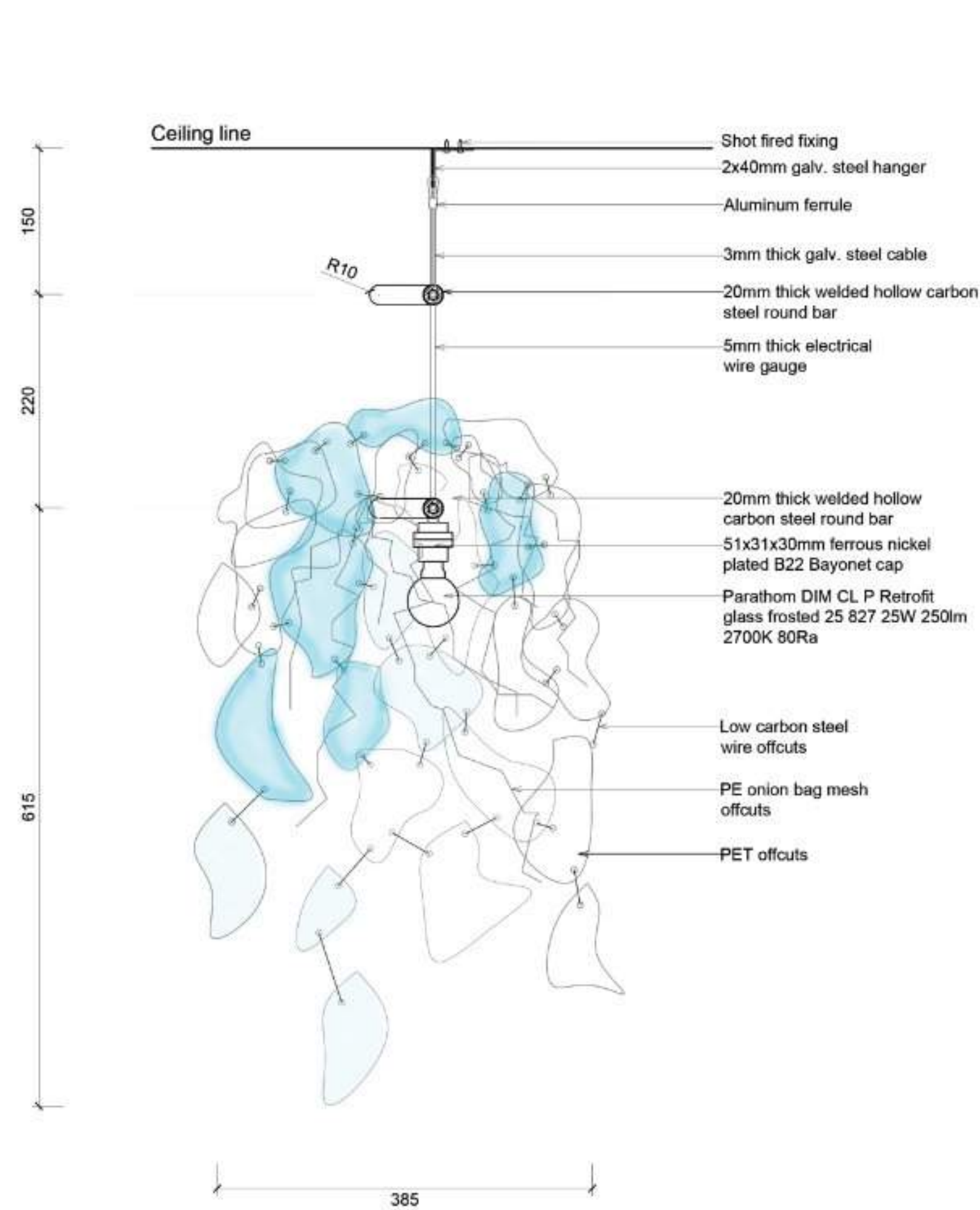
plan

process



section a-a

final

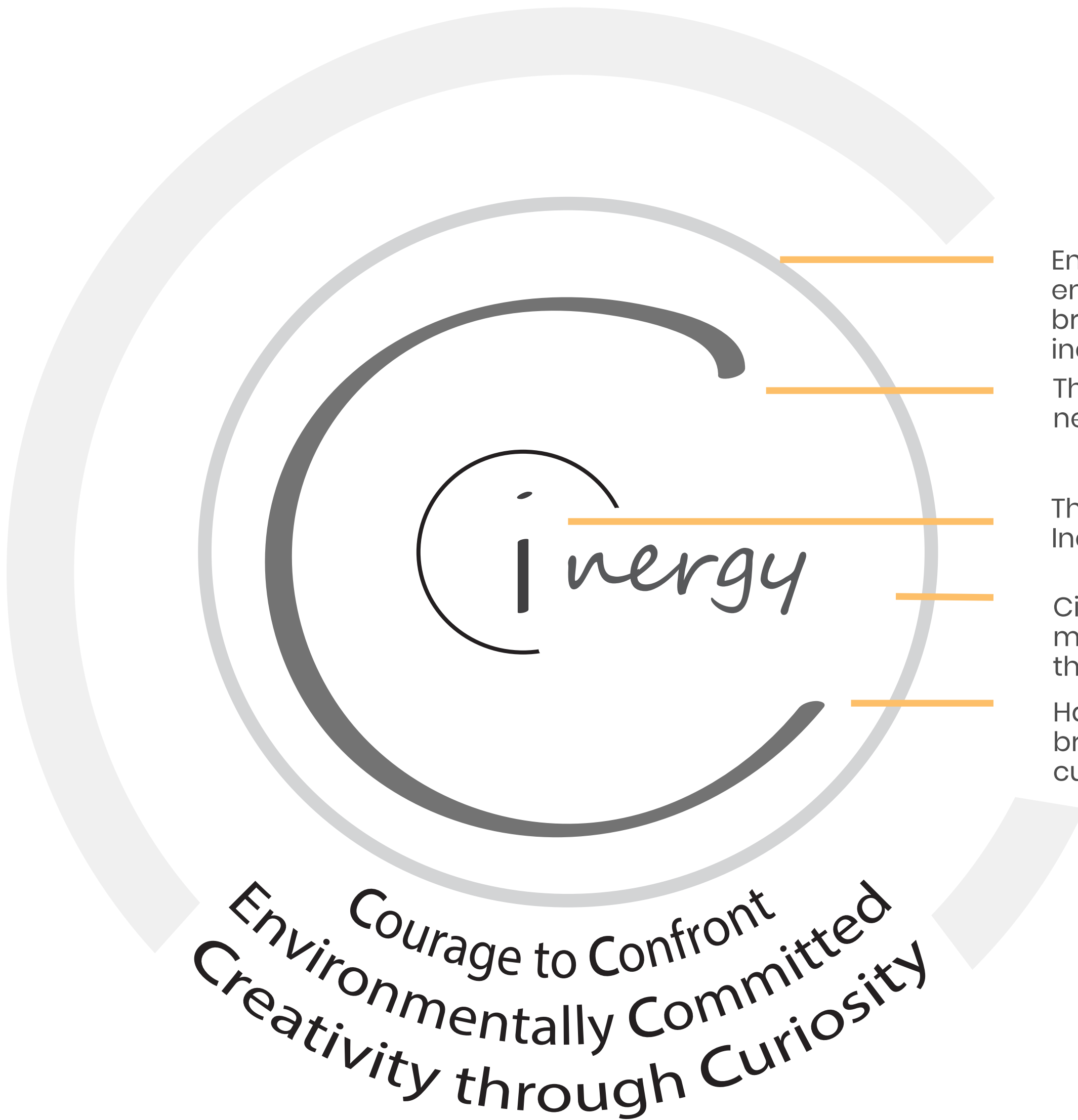


section b-b

Branding

cinergy

Cinergy sensually and energetically promotes *health and sustainability* to our planet. It encourages *minimalism* by focusing on what is essential and it strives to create a *comfortably provocative* atmosphere that feeds *curiosity* and forces the mind to confront difficult issues that relate specifically to our *oceans* where increasingly the worlds waste ends up.

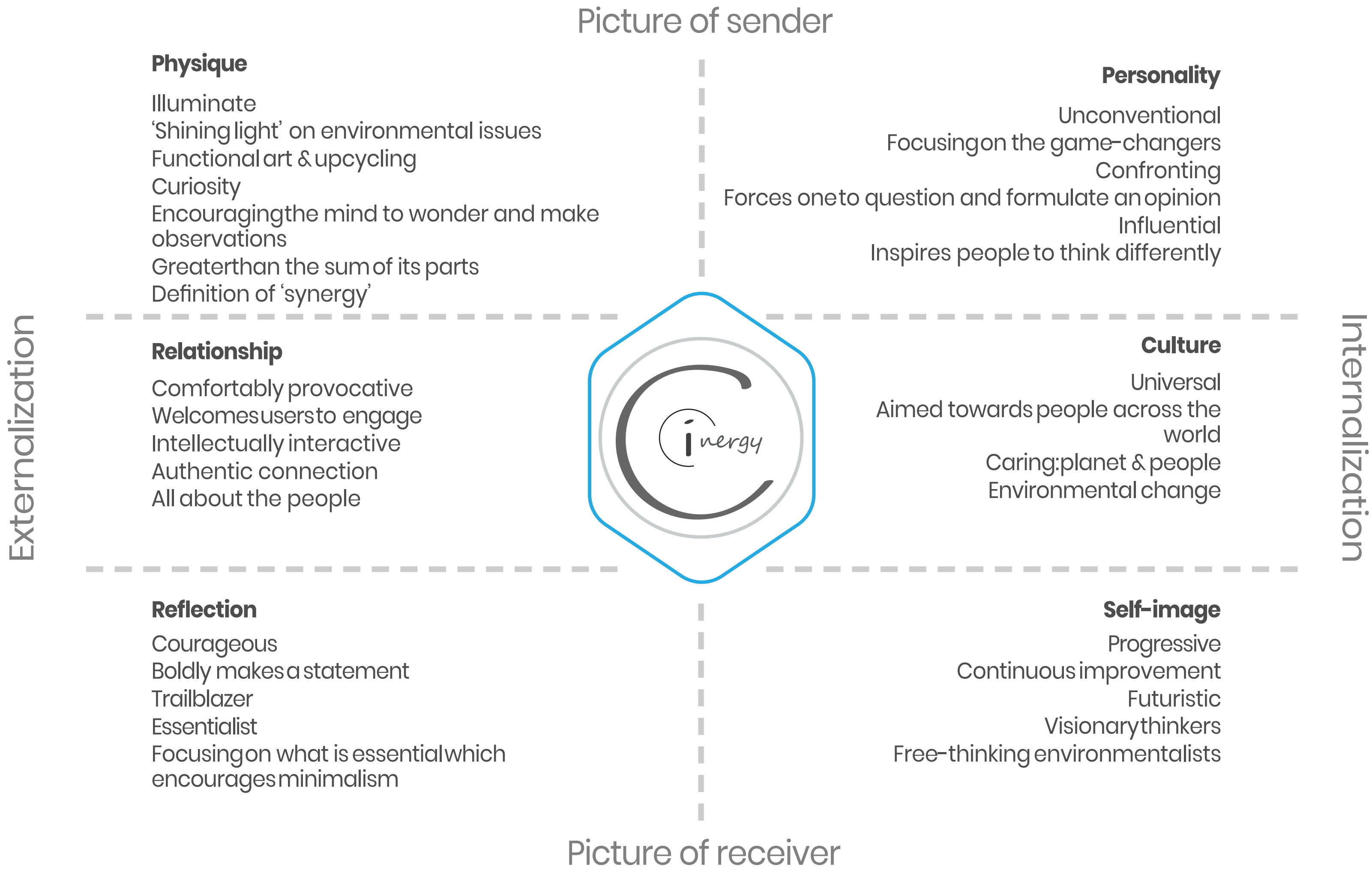


Energy is rooted in the lovemark name as it emphasizes the dynamic and lively qualities of the brand as well as the active role the collective individual has on creating a wholesome planet for all. The 'C' replaces the 'S' in order to create a much needed innovative synergy.

The emphasis on the 'i' is the Impact that each individual has on this planet.

Cinergy is derived from the word 'synergy' which means the creating of a whole which is greater than the simple sum of its parts.

Handwritten style font to create a more personal brand identity that emphasizes the handcrafted and customised products.

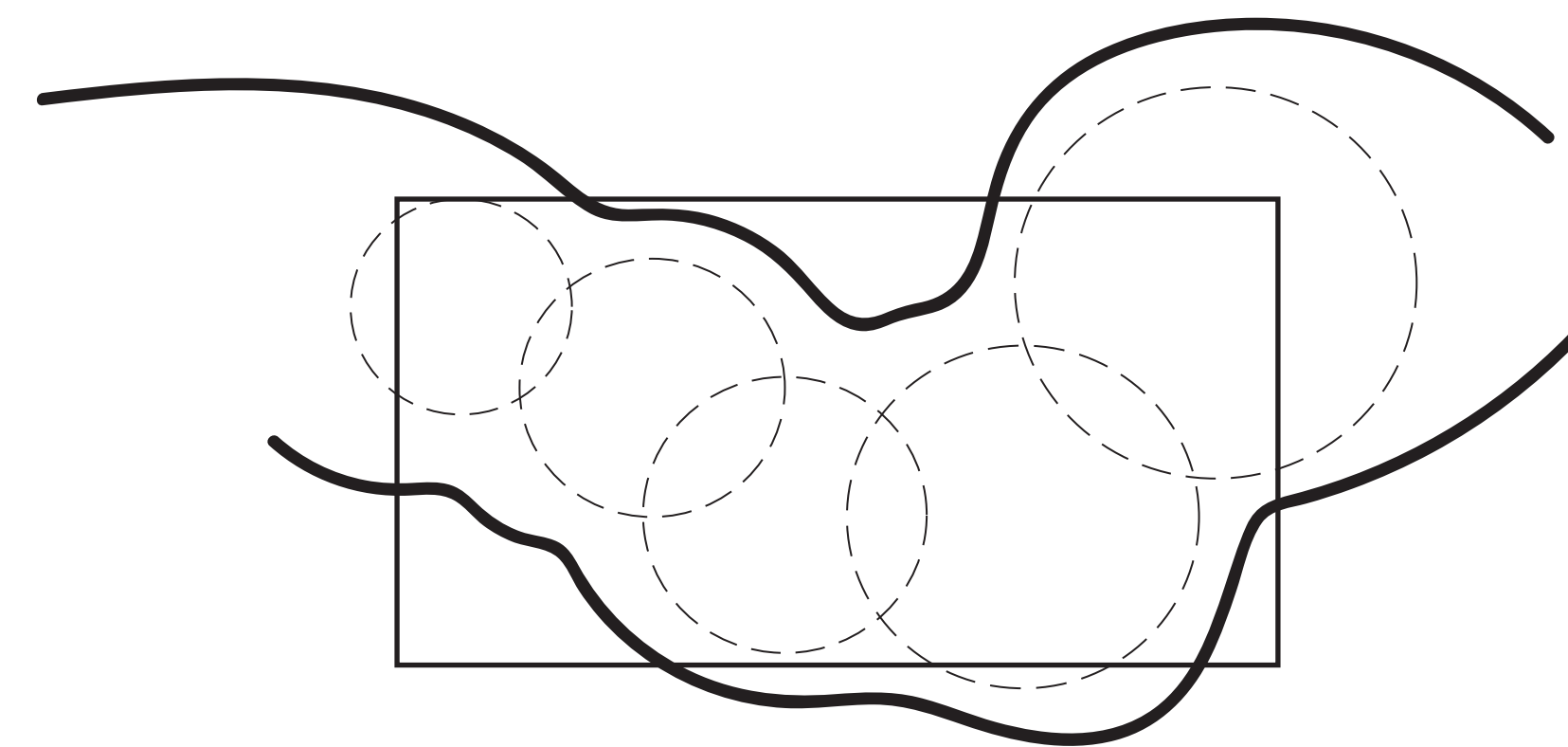


Design Principles

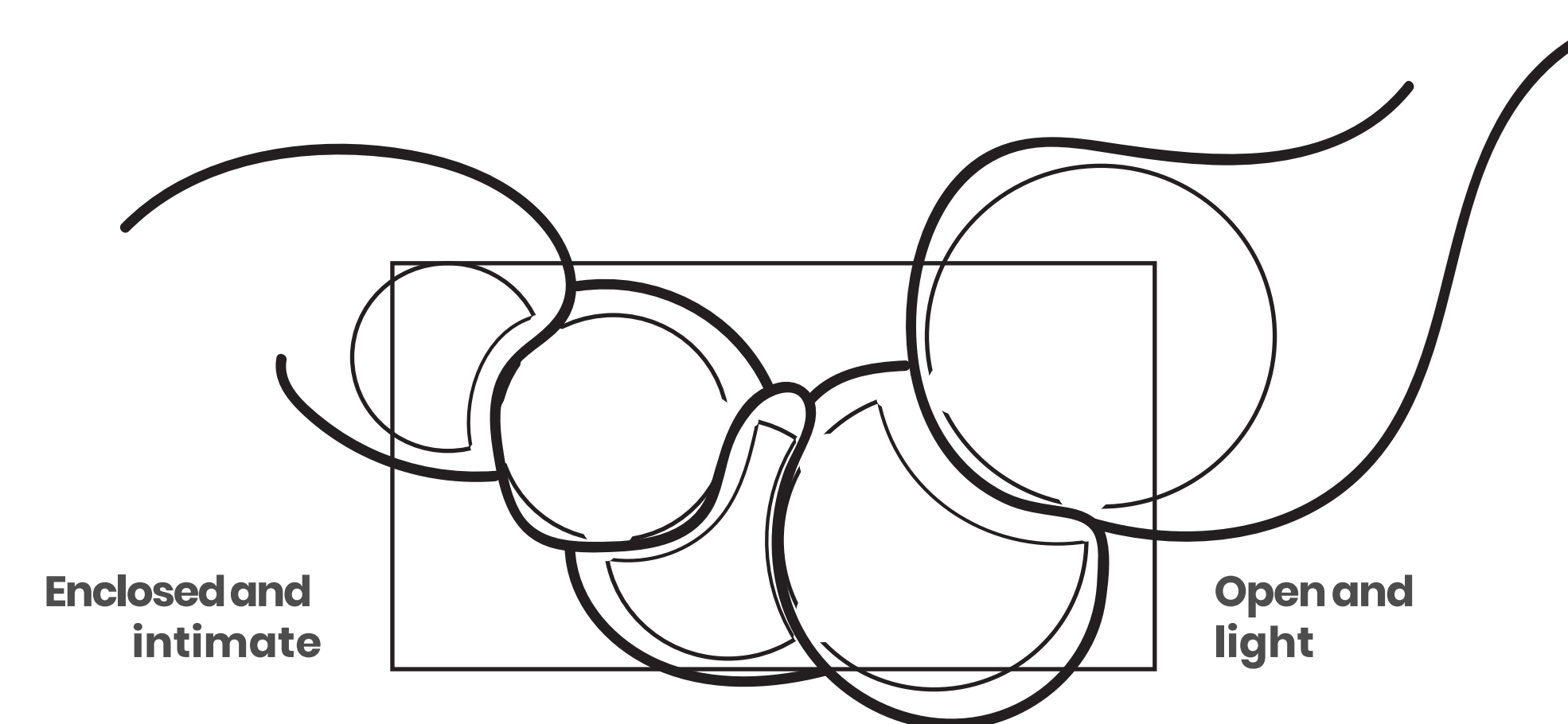
concept statement

Creating a synergetic environment between the relationship of the *collective in the inner city* and the seemingly *disparate environmental awareness of plastic wastage* floating among our oceans.

Spatial Concept

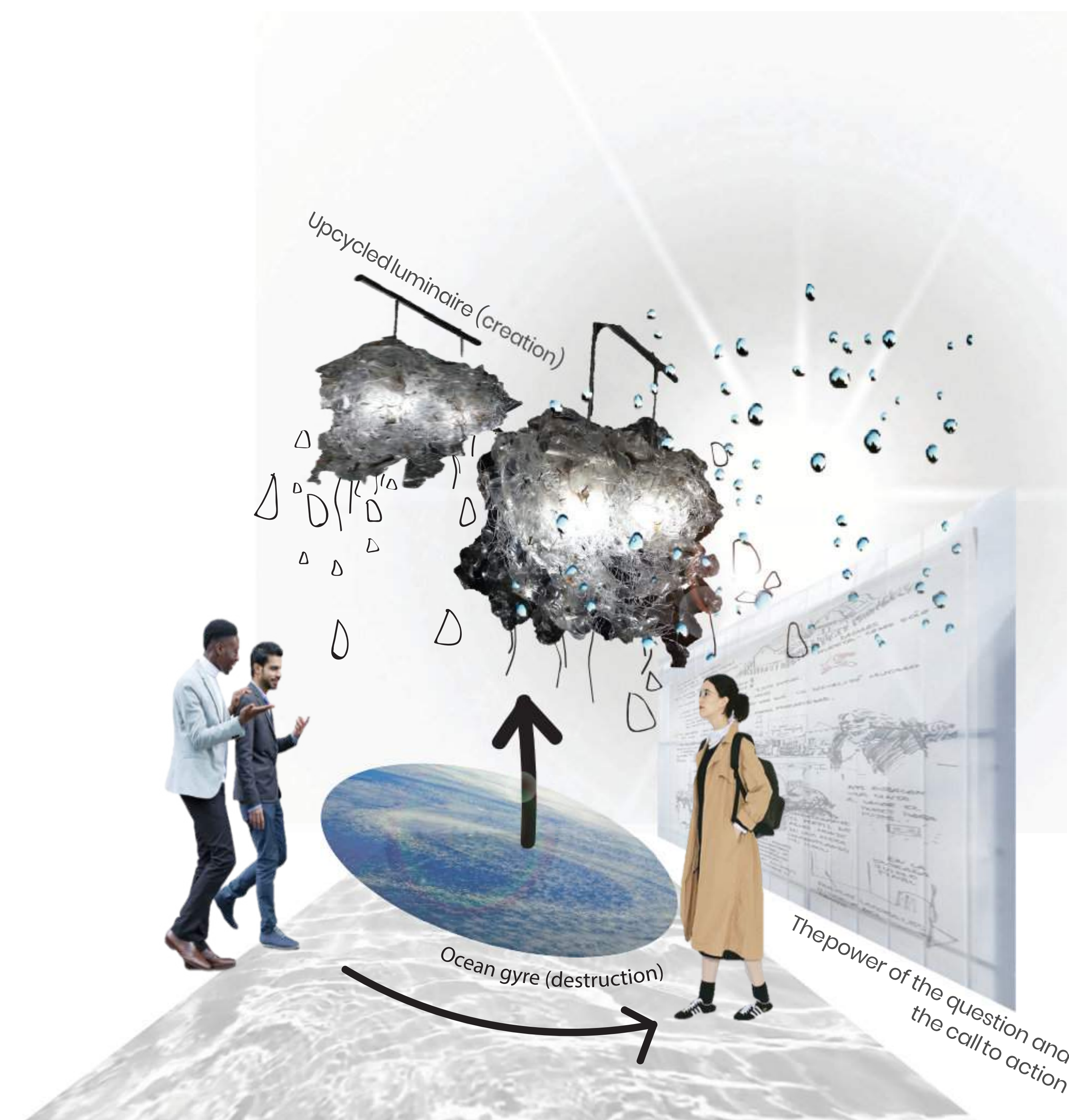


A series of *interlinking, integrative spaces* representing *ocean gyres* that bring people together to create an environmentally conscious generation through the power of the collective. These interlinking parts create a system that makes up the larger, more impactful whole.



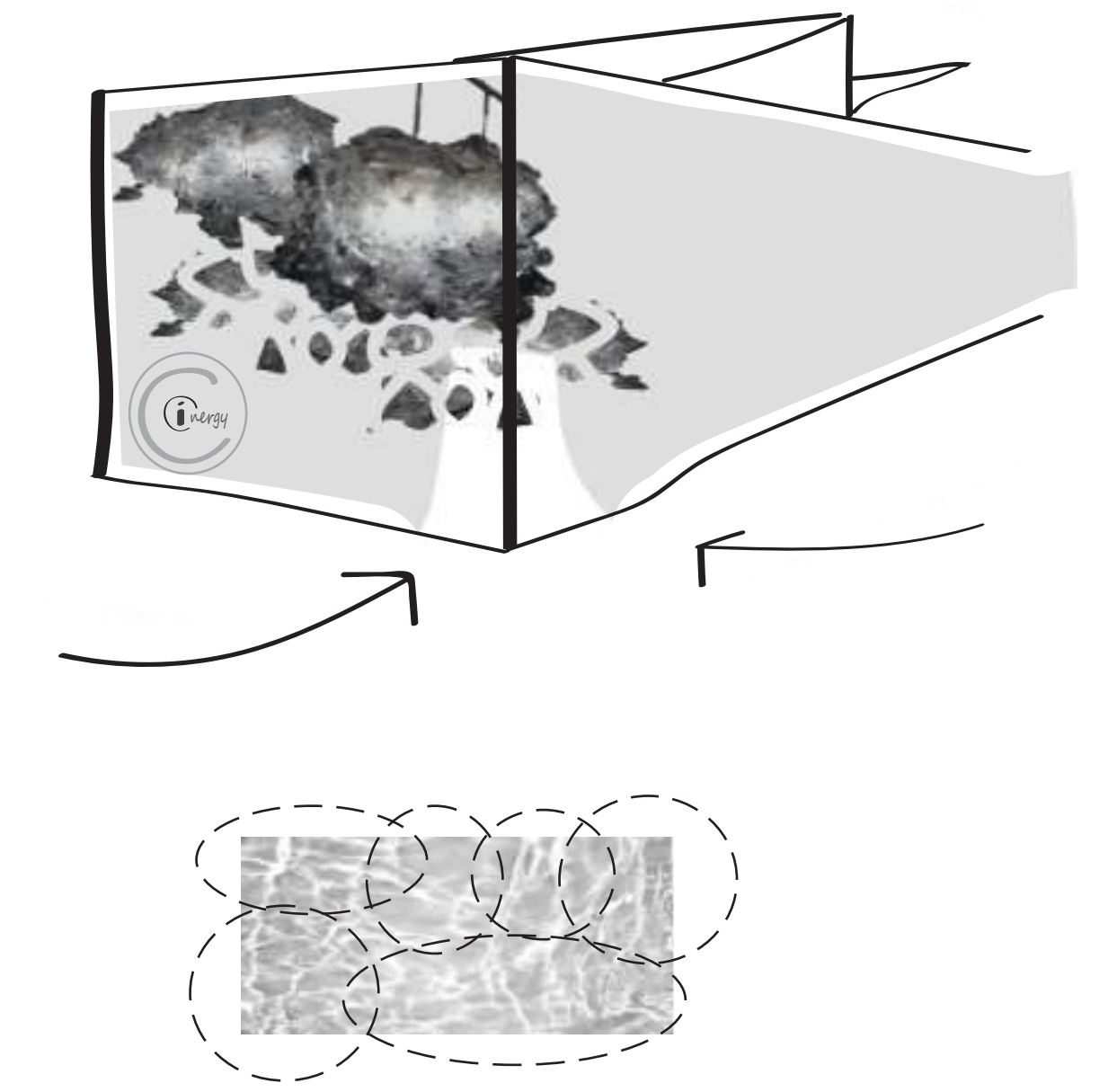
Paths of movement are cut through the ocean gyres reflecting the *impact* that us as *human beings* can have on the gyres and it enforces the fact that we are all part of the *same system* making up the larger whole.

Luminaire Concept



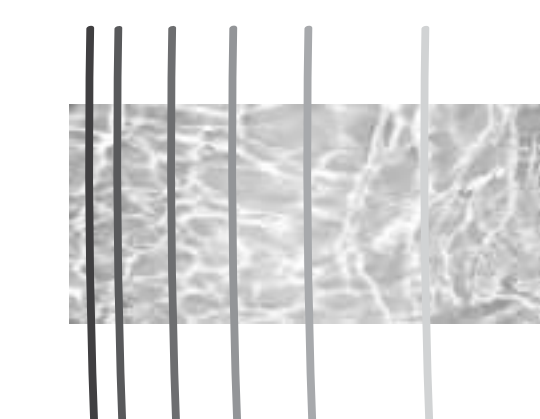
Creating a *provocative* connection between the plastic gyres within our oceans and the *bespoke upcycled luminaire* that could have potentially been a part of the gyres. As a result, *creation has come from destruction*.

Mystery



Welcoming *curious minds* to question the world around them by incorporating the *synergetic* concept of the parts coming together as a more impactful whole. Each space sparks curiosity.

Intimacy



Creating an awareness of the *plastic pollution crisis* by aiming the individuals attention towards the message being communicated by the upcycled luminaire. Cinergy seeks to create an environment that is *committed to it's people and the environment* which will encourage users to do the same. *The further one moves in, the more truth starts to be revealed.*

Sensuality



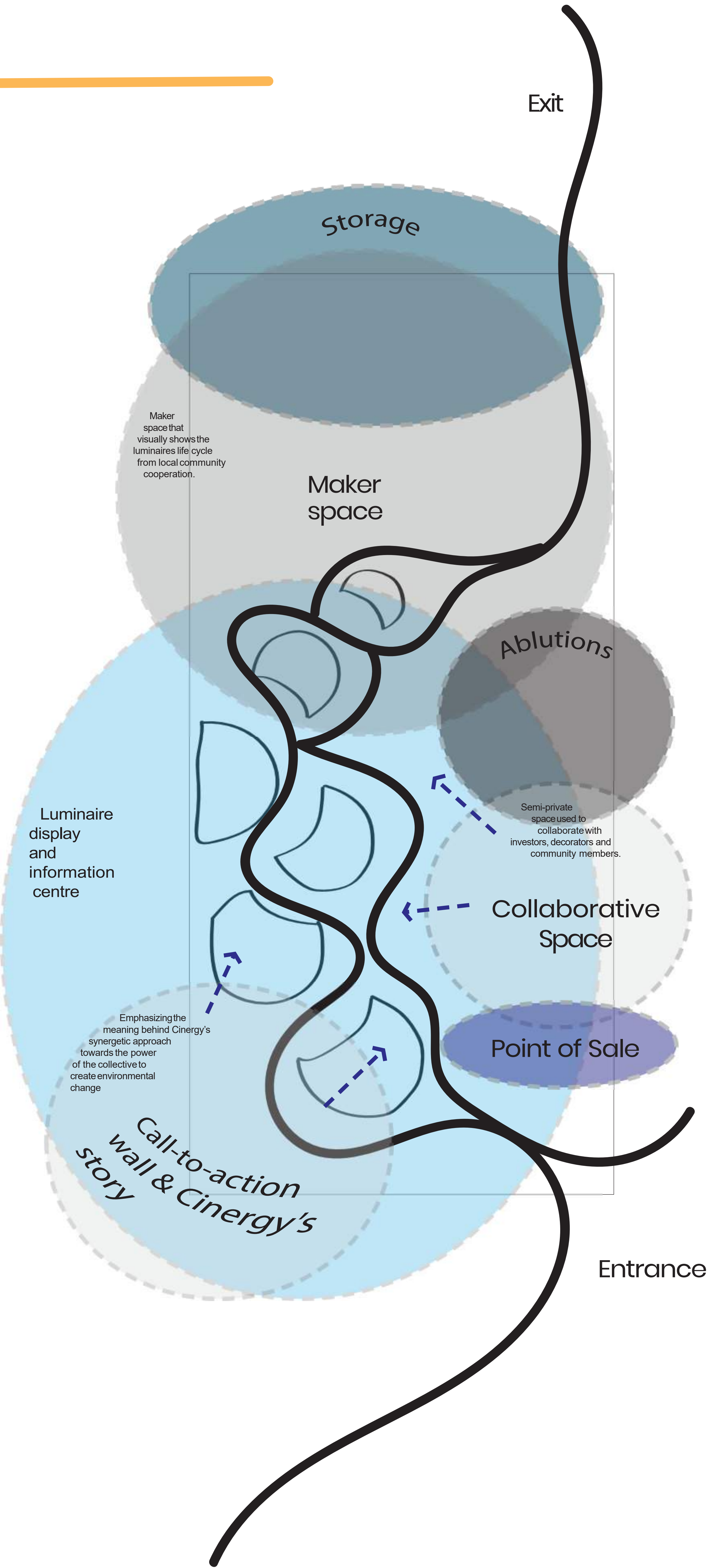
Bringing *qualities of the ocean* to an interior environment that speak to the senses.

Space Planning

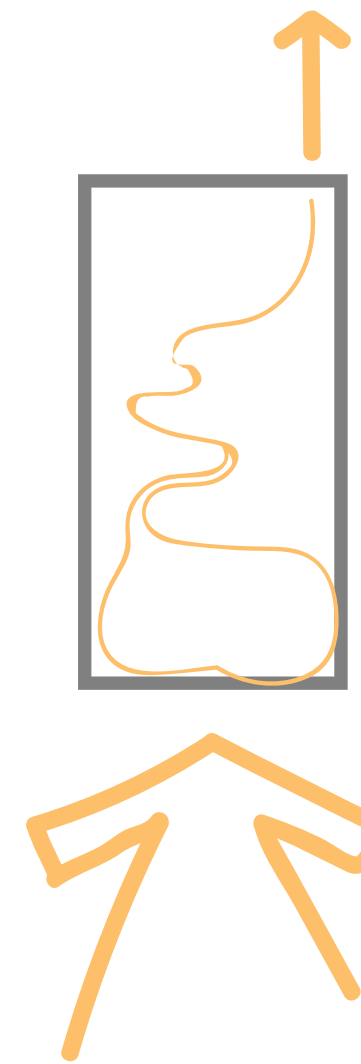
zoning

Creating synergy through a fluid and integrative environment that engages the curious individuals in order to unite as a collective.

The entrance flows into the luminaire display in the double volume in order to draw focus on this star product of the store. This is integrated with the supporting programme which is the information centre. This flows into the maker space which creates a journey for the users to discover the environmental plastic waste secrets behind the bespoke luminaire.

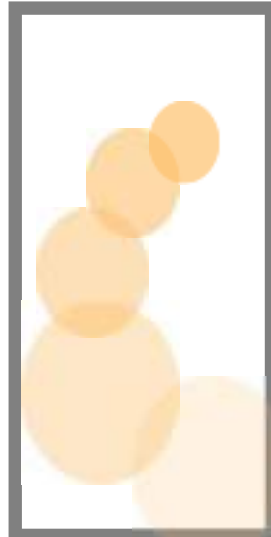


Movement



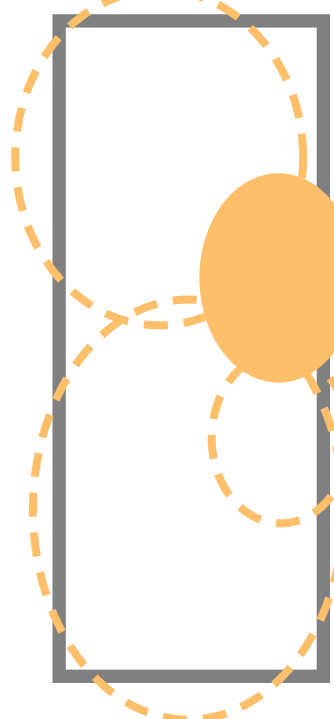
Dynamically channelled from a larger space of movement towards a more confined space.

Hierarchy



The further one goes within the Creative Incubator, the higher the platforms become, the more intimate the spaces get and the smaller the luminaires get.

Integration vs Segregation



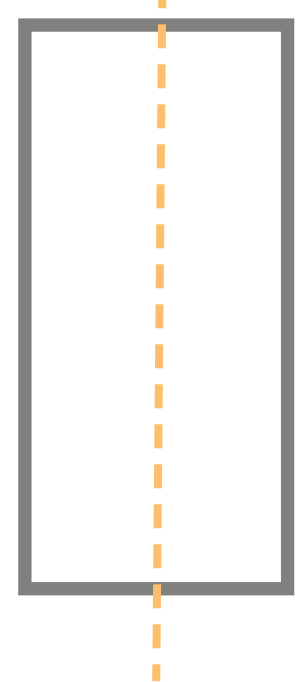
Cinergy is an integrative environment that draws people together because the collective is more powerful than the individual. The ablution facility is segregated.

Openness vs Closure



The retail space is much more light and open due to the double volume and its north facing nature. This creates a fresh approach when entering the store. The further one goes into the store, the more intimate and darker the spaces become.

Axis



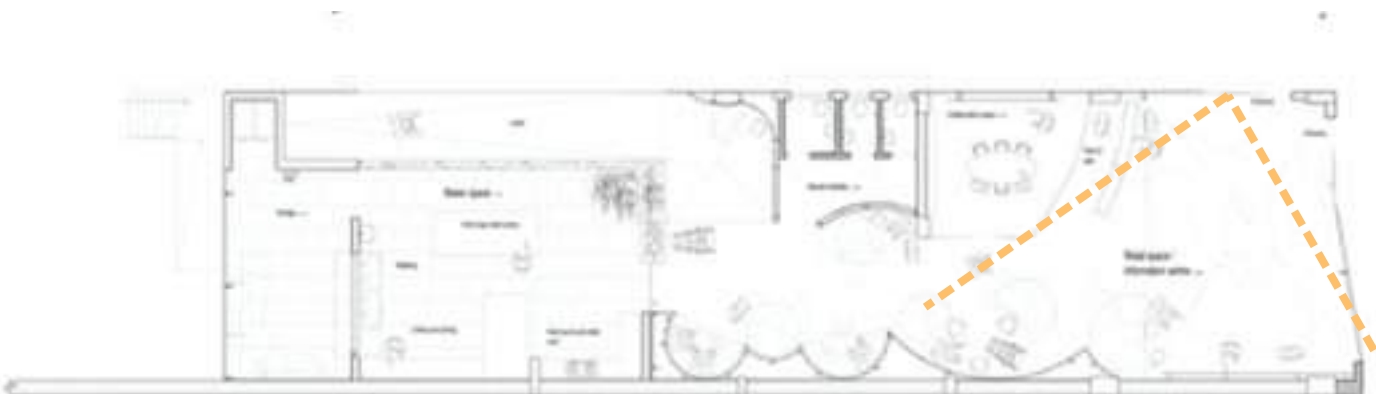
The story of the luminaire from resources to product. Individuals can enter from one end and exit from the other.

ground floor plan

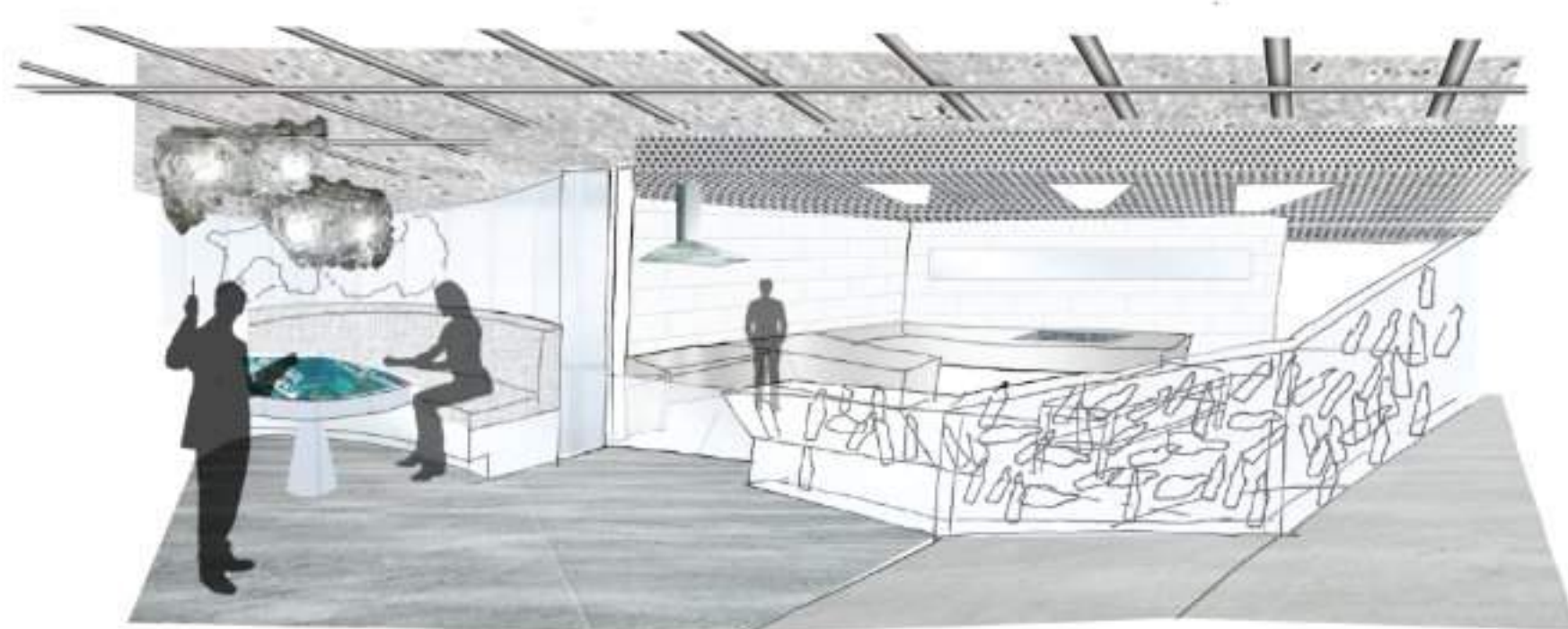
Product & Programme

Star product: Upcycled luminaire
Supporting programme: information centre

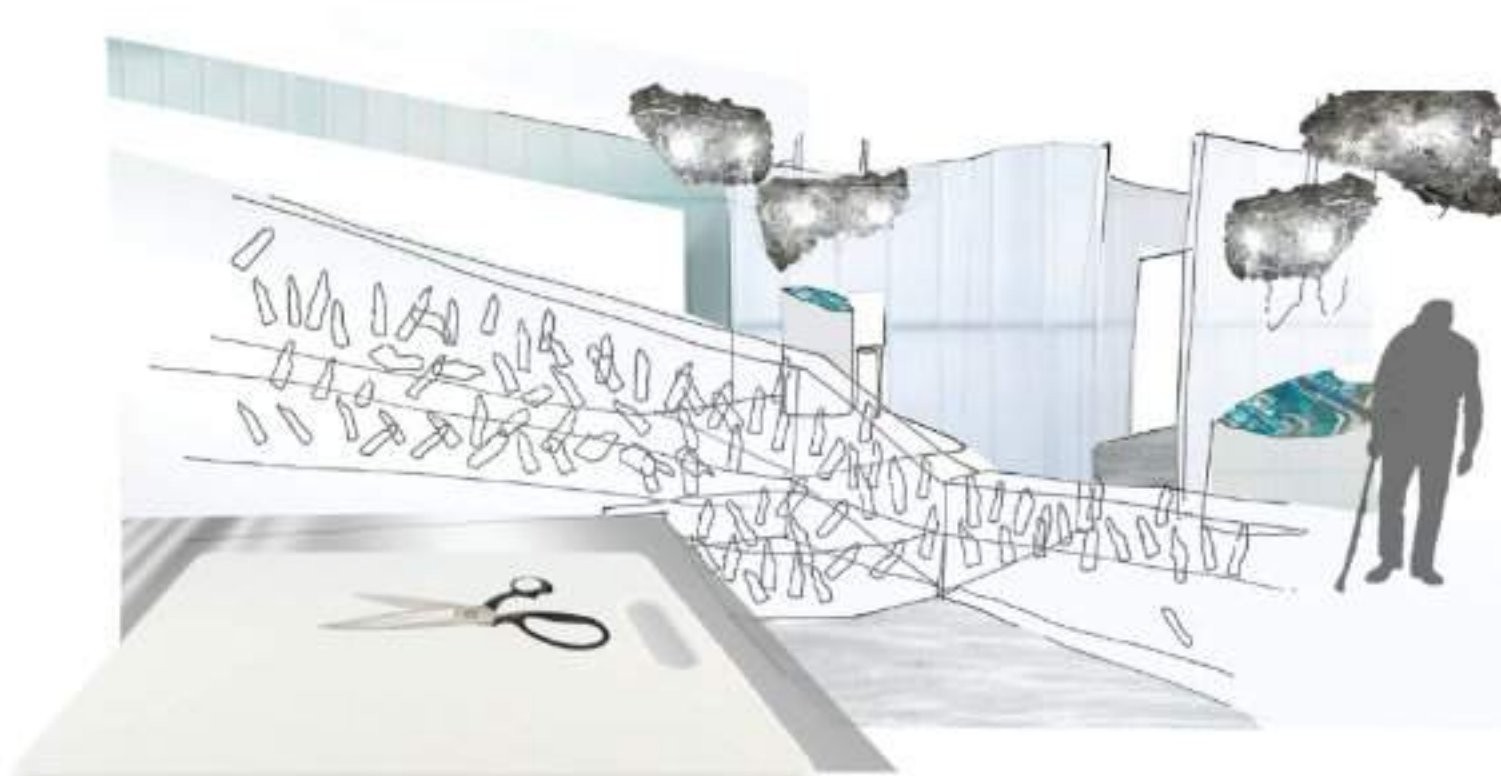
The further one goes within the creative incubator, the higher the platforms become, the more intimate the spaces get and the smaller the luminaires become as one is led towards the environmental secrets – plastic waste – behind the luminaire (which is witnessed in the Makerspace).



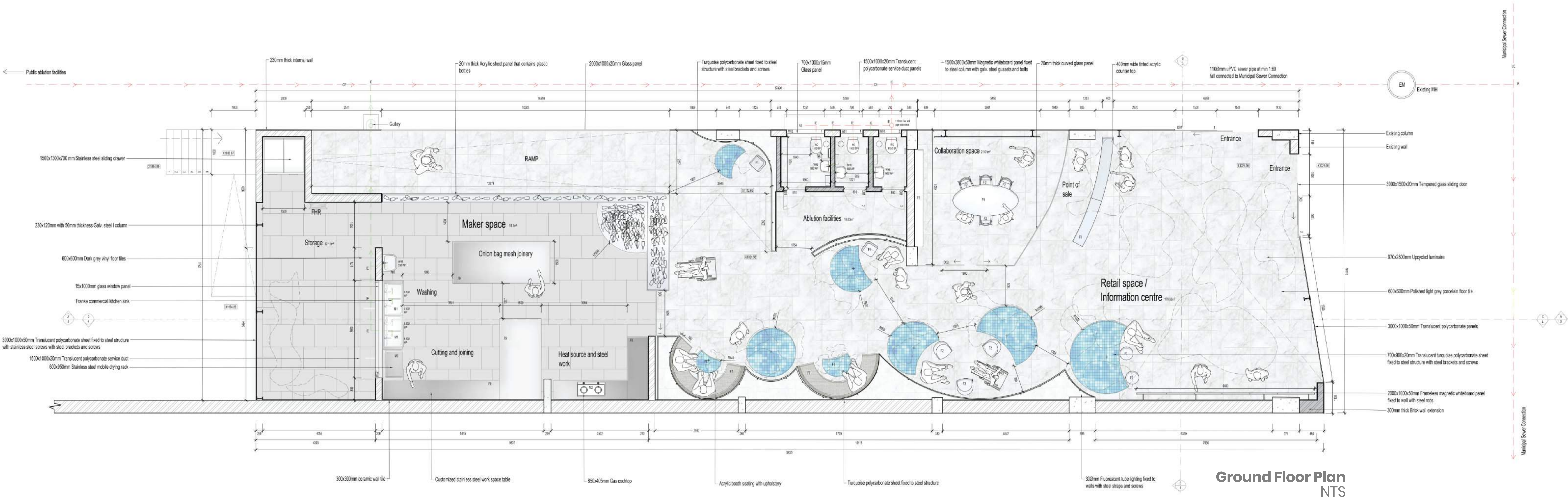
Alley way entrance looking towards opposite end of double volume.



Looking towards maker space from the landing on the ramp.



Looking towards ramp and ablation facilities from maker space

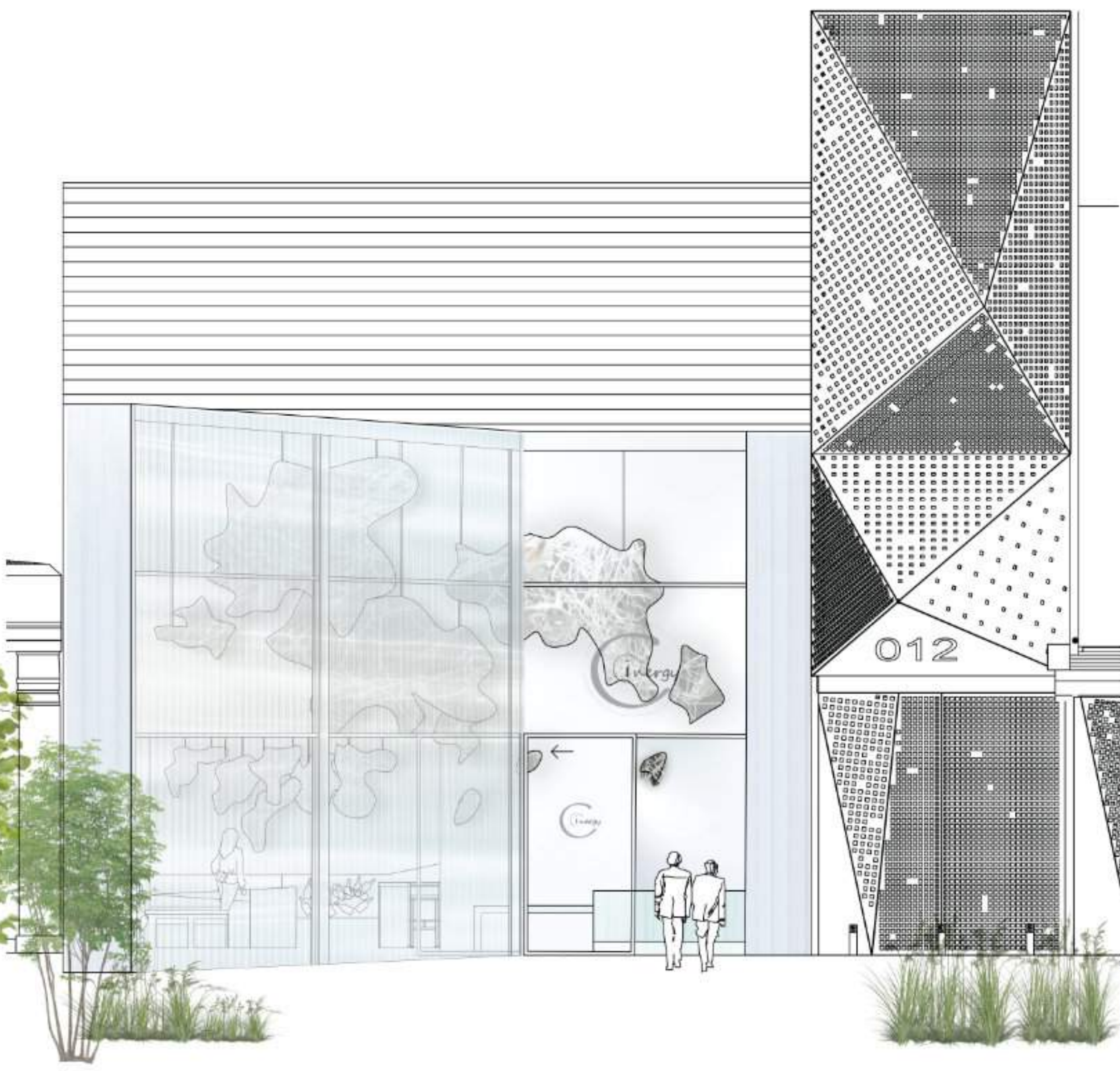
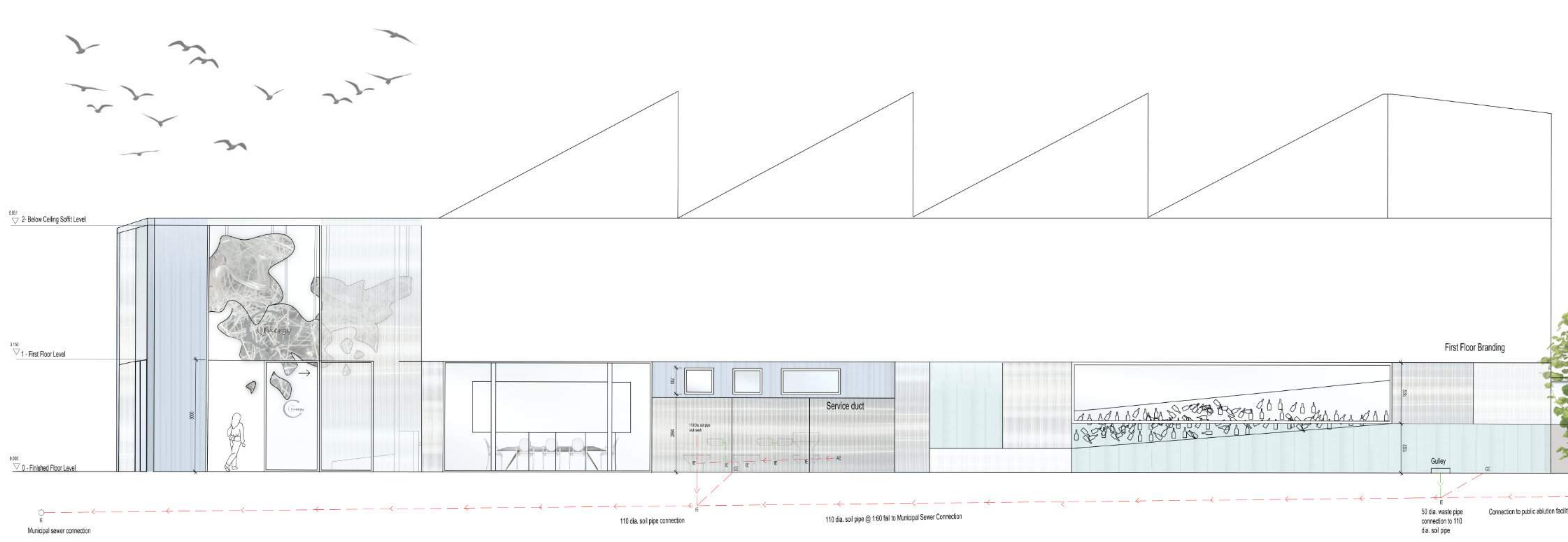
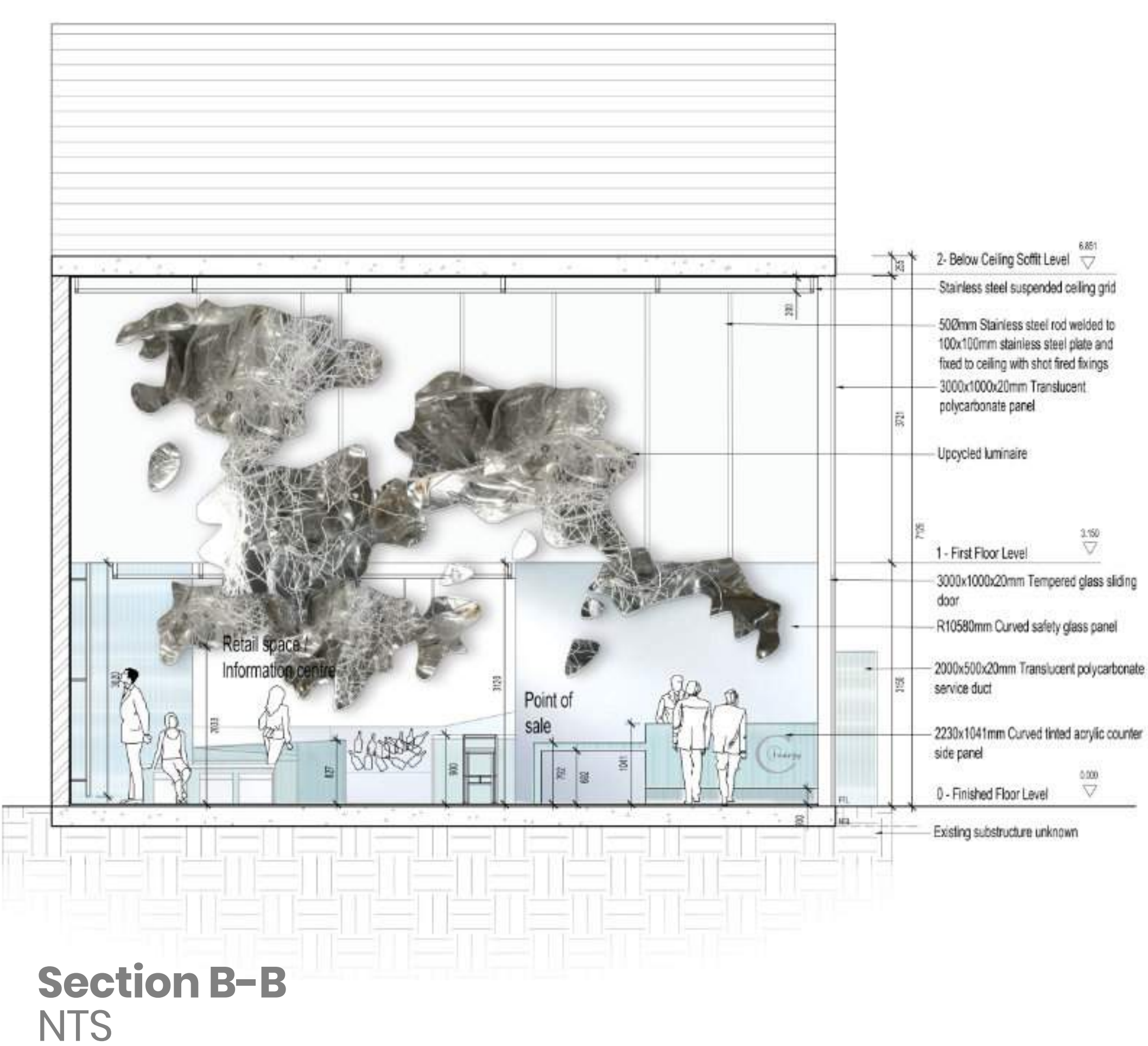
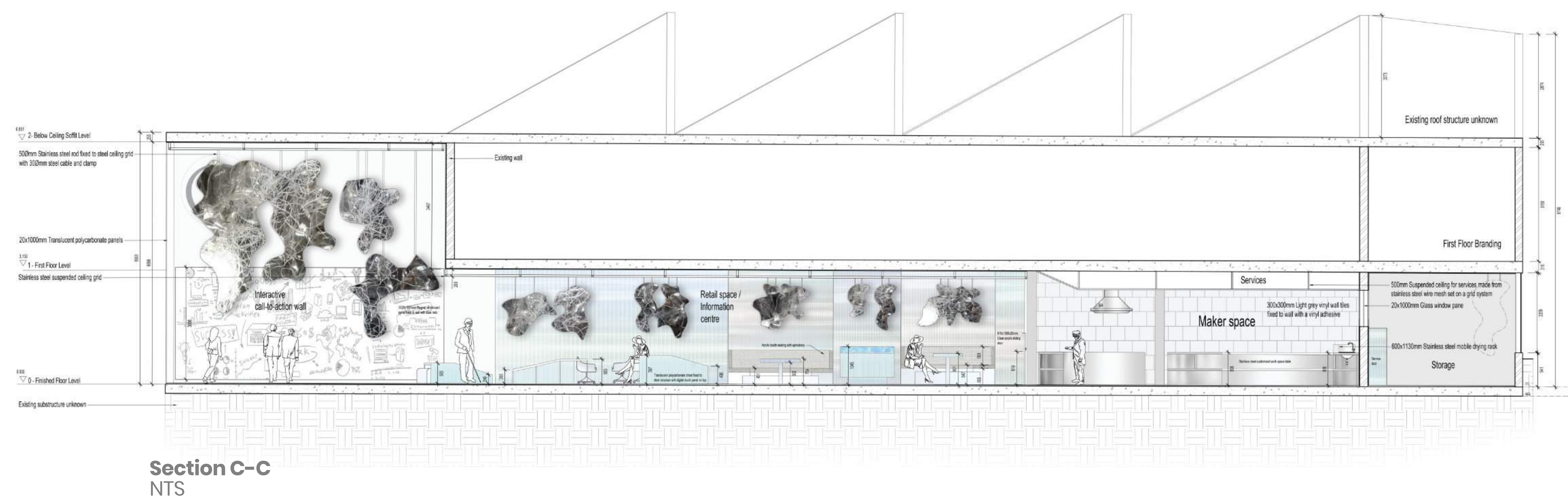


sections & elevations

Material Strategy

The play between *translucent* and *transparent* materials transports users to an ocean environment that spreads awareness about plastic wastage floating among our waters.

Sustainable materials are chosen in order to adhere to the message being conveyed by the luminaires. These materials can either *contribute* to the cycle of the luminaires or be *recycled* after use.



Western Elevation
NTS

Northern Elevation
NTS

Reflection

challenges & opportunities

Designing an upcycled luminaire that was both *functional and aesthetically compelling* was one of the most difficult aspects of this project. *Sourcing recycled materials, prototyping, and experimenting* with different lighting techniques required *extensive trial and error*, testing, and refinement. Each iteration presented new technical and creative challenges, pushing me to think critically about material behavior, light quality, and sustainability.

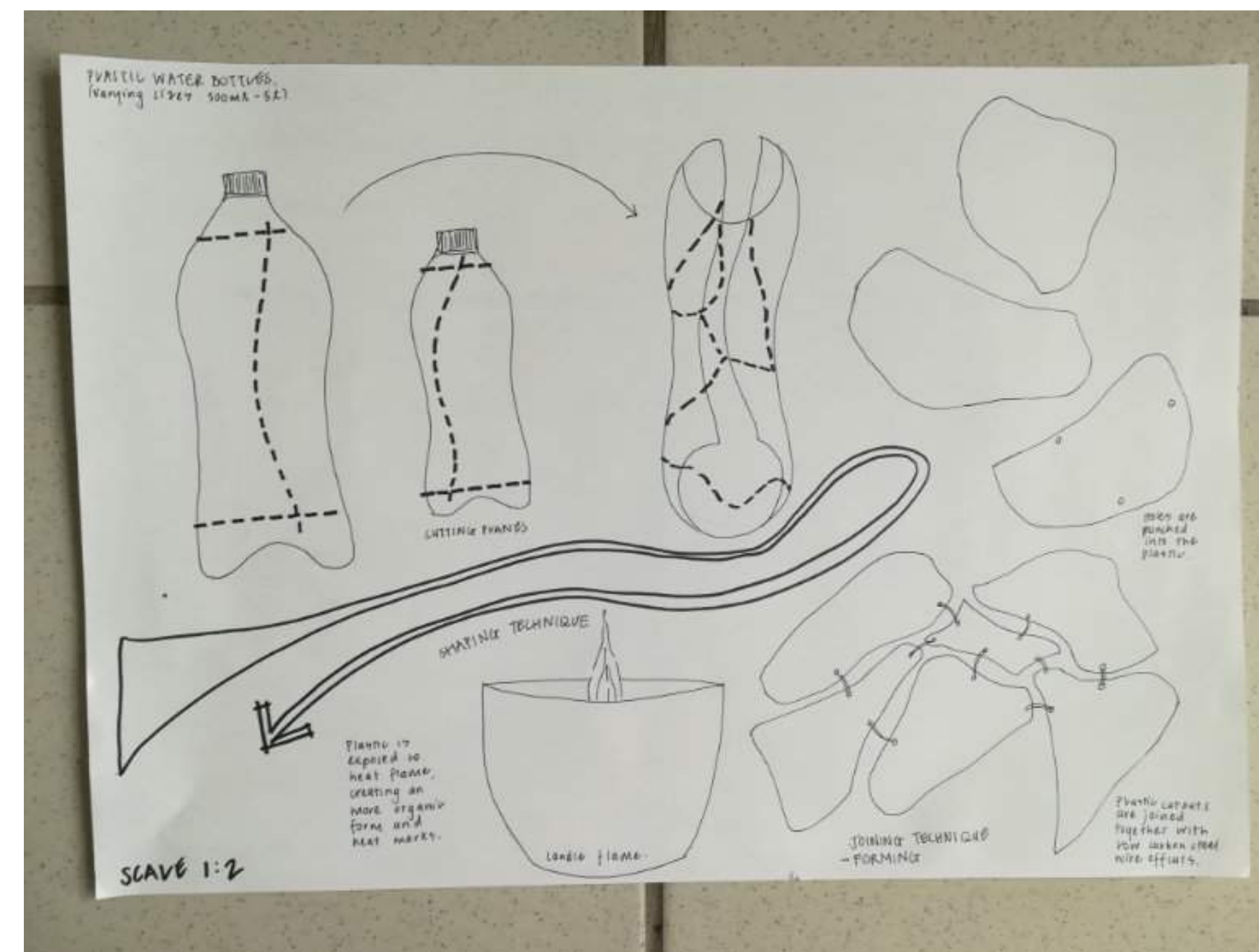
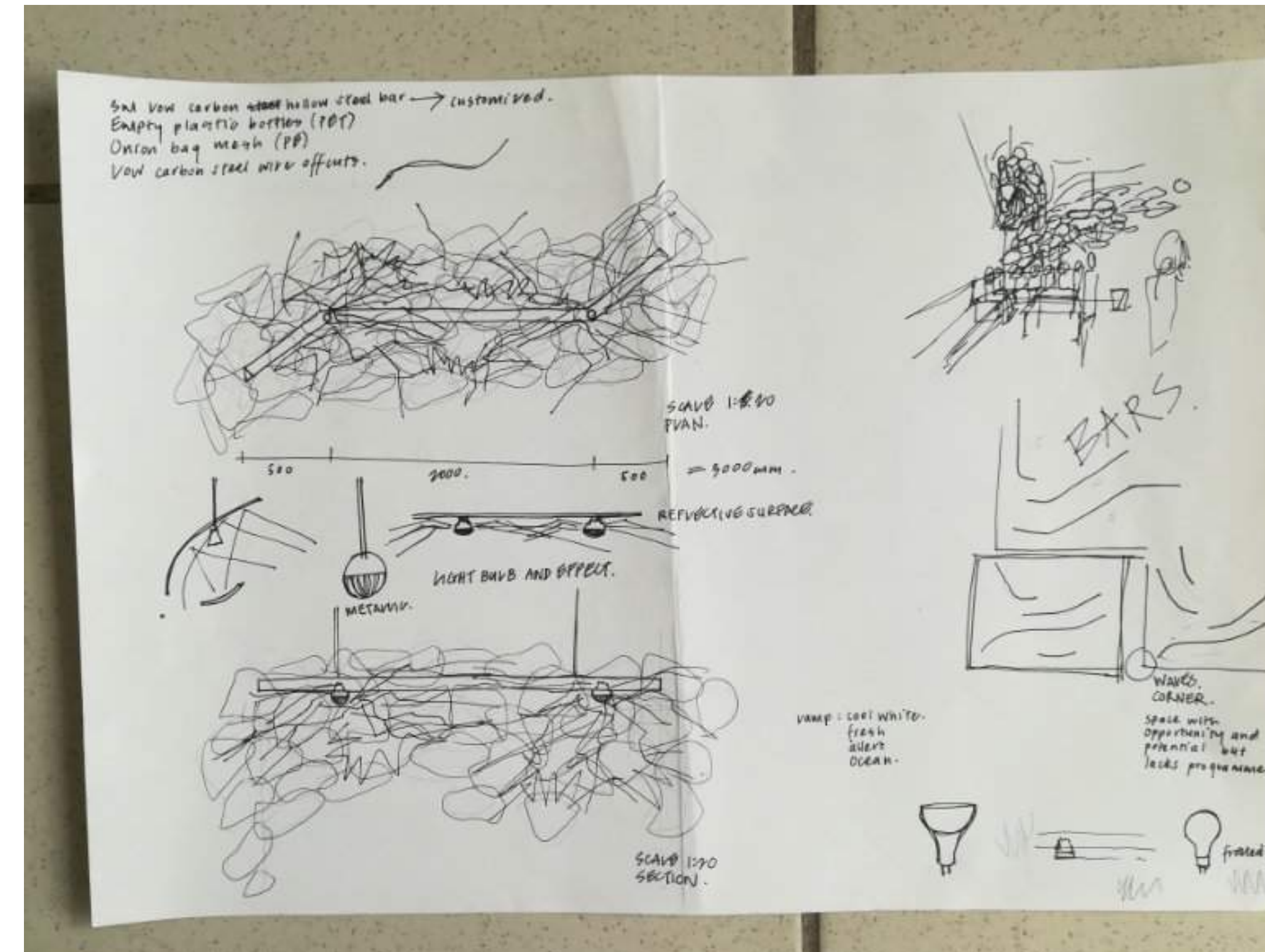
In addition, *designing a retail space that complemented and showcased the luminaire* added another layer of complexity. This required careful consideration of spatial flow, material cohesion, and user experience, ensuring the *environment reflected the values and character of the product*. While these challenges were demanding, they offered rich opportunities for experimentation, problem-solving, and developing a deeper understanding of *how product design and interior architecture can interact harmoniously*.

accomplishments

The project was awarded a distinction.

personal growth & insights

This project deepened my understanding of *circular design principles, teaching me to creatively repurpose materials while maintaining functionality and aesthetic quality*. Prototyping with upcycled components encouraged *experimentation*, while integrating the luminaire into a retail space reinforced *holistic, sustainable thinking*. The process enhanced my *commitment to environmentally conscious, user-centered design—insights that continue to guide my creative approach*.



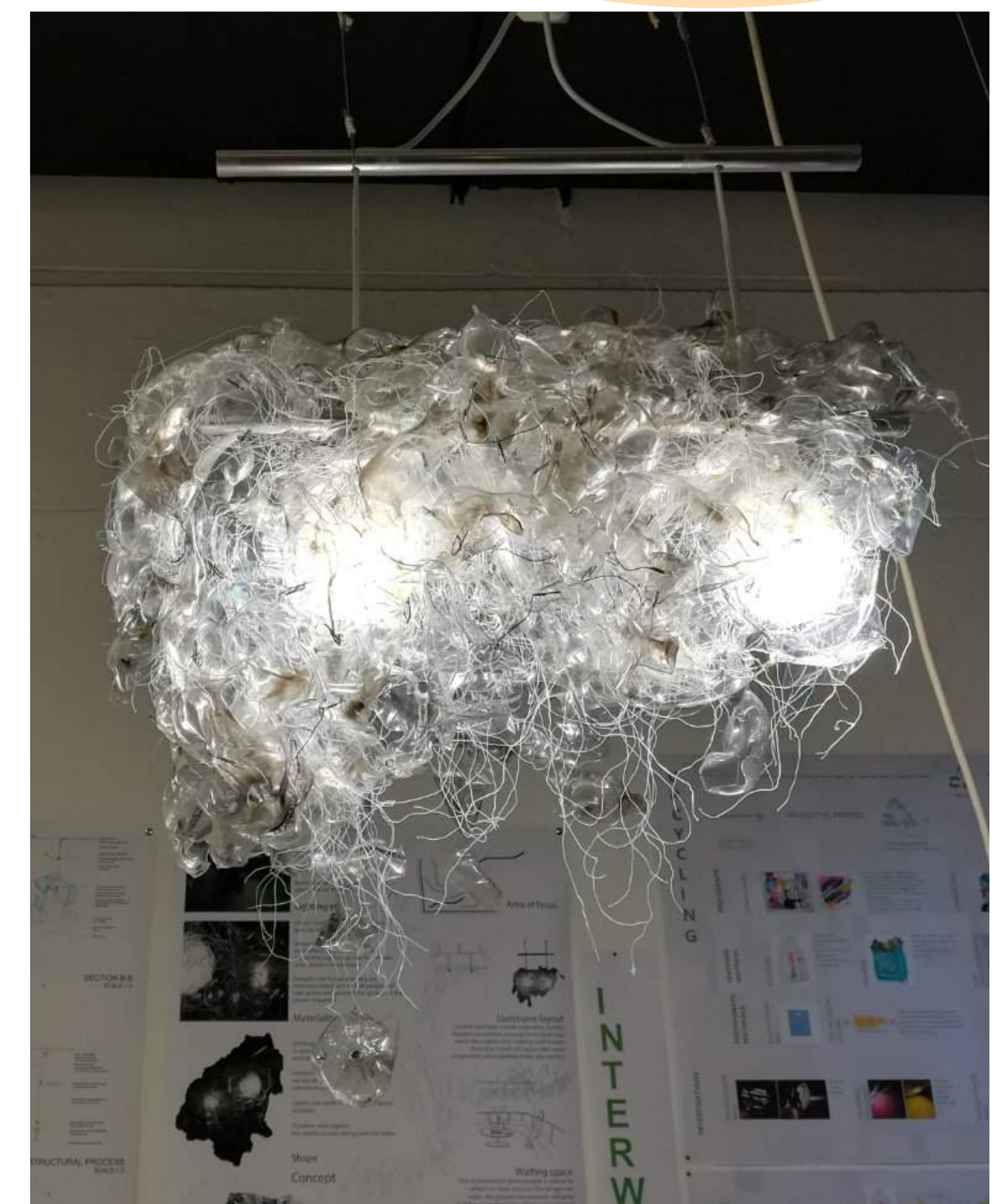
Brainstorming design ideas and joinery techniques for the luminaire.



Images depicting lighting effects from different joinery techniques, recycled materials and shapes for the luminaire.



Experimenting with different recycled materials, shapes and joinery techniques for the luminaire.



Final outcome of the designed and developed luminaire.